. ENG505 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM by Vu Gateway

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG505) Language Learning Theories

Lesson-06

GENERATIVISM-1

Topic-022: Nativism and LAD

What is Chomsky's idea of innateness in language learning?

Chomsky's idea of innateness suggests that children have innate knowledge that helps them learn a language quickly.

What is the Language Acquisition Device (LAD) according to Chomsky?

The LAD is a hypothetical mental mechanism that contains innate knowledge and rules for language acquisition.

How does MacNeill support the existence of LAD?

MacNeill supports the LAD by pointing out the ability to distinguish speech sounds, organize linguistic data, recognize the possibility of certain linguistic systems, and engage in constant evaluation.

What is Chomsky's concept of innateness, and how does it relate to language learning?

Chomsky's idea of innateness refers to the notion that certain fundamental language knowledge is inherently present in humans. This concept explains a child's ability to master a native language quickly despite the abstract nature of language rules. Chomsky introduced the Language Acquisition Device (LAD) to represent this innate knowledge, which encompasses fundamental language rules, the universality of language acquisition across cultures, and expected language errors in children.

Topic-023: Chomsky's Criticism on Behaviourism

How did Chomsky critique behaviorism, particularly B.F. Skinner's ideas?
Chomsky criticized behaviorism by challenging the idea that language learning is solely based on repetition and reinforcement.

What did Chomsky argue about a child's language abilities?
Chomsky argued that children have the ability to create infinite sentences and phrases they've never heard before using a finite set of rules.

How did Chomsky criticize B.F. Skinner's behaviorism in relation to language acquisition?
Chomsky's criticism of behaviorism, particularly Skinner's views, centered on the idea that language learning cannot be solely explained by repetition and reinforcement. Chomsky believed that children possess the ability to use a finite set of rules to generate an infinite number of sentences, even ones they have never heard before.

Topic-024: Rene Descartes's Concept of Idea

What is Rene Descartes's famous philosophical statement?
Rene Descartes's famous statement is "I think, therefore I am."

How did Descartes classify ideas?
Descartes classified ideas into three types: innate ideas, adventitious ideas, and factitious ideas.

According to Descartes, what determines truth and reality?
Descartes believed that knowledge or belief in God determines truth and reality.

Topic-025: Transcendental Idealism

Who proposed the theory of Transcendental Idealism?
Immanuel Kant proposed the theory of Transcendental Idealism.

What is the key idea of Transcendental Idealism regarding human perception and the world?
It suggests that the human mind creates individual experiences, and the world is independent of individual perceptions.

What are the key features of Transcendental Idealism?
Features include concepts without perceptions being empty, perceptions without concepts being blind, and the distinction between the phenomenal and noumenal realms.

Topic-026: The Lenneberg Theory and Competence and Performance What is the Critical Period Hypothesis (CPH) according to the Lenneberg theory?

CPH suggests that successful language acquisition occurs before puberty, emphasizing the importance of learning during childhood and the existence of neurological mechanisms.

What is the difference between Competence and Performance in language?

Competence refers to a native speaker's knowledge of language rules, while Performance is the actual use of language in real situations.

Who supported Chomsky's concept of performance and proposed additional ideas?

Dell Hymes supported Chomsky's concept of performance and added that language is one mode of communication, it varies in different situations, and language acquisition is subject to social needs.

Lesson-07

GENERATIVISM-II

Topic-027: Dispelling Myths Critical Period Hypothesis

What is the relevance of second language acquisition to the critical period hypothesis?

It highlights the age factor and the belief that children as L2 learners are 'superior' to adults.

Who argued that CPH has been dispelled as a myth to investigate first language acquisition and SLA?

H. H. Stern (1970) gave arguments for better understanding.

What are some of the principles that Stern mentioned for language learning in childhood and SLA?

Practice, repetition, imitation, practicing separate sounds, understanding before speaking, natural learning order, learning without translation, and no explicit grammar teaching.

Topic-028: Introduction to Universal Grammar

How does Chomsky define Universal Grammar (UG)?

Chomsky defines UG as 'the system of principles, conditions, and rules that are elements or properties of all human languages... the essence of human language.'

What are some arguments in support of UG?

Arguments include universality, convergence, poverty of the stimulus, no negative evidence, child's easy acquisition, uniformity, maturational effects, dissociation between language and cognition, and neurological separation.

What does Chomsky's UG attempt to explain?

It attempts to explain what constitutes knowledge of language, how it is acquired, and put to use.

Topic-029: Principles and Parameters

What are Principles and Parameters in Universal Grammar (UG)?

Principles are universal and apply to all human languages, while parameters vary from one language to another based on language input.

What is the key difference between Principles and Parameters?

Principles are structure dependent, relying on the structural relationship in sentences, while parameters vary according to language input.

Can you name a few examples of parameters?

Examples of parameters include the Pro-Drop Parameter, Binary Parameter, HeadInitial Parameter, Head-Final Parameter, and Governing Parameters.

Topic-030: UG-Based Approaches to SLA

What is the primary focus of Universal Grammar (UG)?

The focus of UG is native language and the way it is acquired.

What are the three models proposed regarding the access to UG by L2 learners?

The direct access model, the indirect access model, and the no-access model.

Which model suggests that L2 learners have partial access to UG?

The Overall Model, proposed by Felix (1985), combines previous models and claims that L2 learners have partial access to UG.

Lesson-08

COGNITIVISM-I

Topic-031: General Learning Theory and Principles

What did cognitivism replace as the dominant paradigm in the 1960s?

Cognitivism replaced behaviorism.

What does cognitivism focus on in psychology?

Cognitivism focuses on mental processes, including perception, thinking, memory, learning, problem-solving, and attention.

According to Mergel (1998), how does cognitivism view behavior?

Mergel (1998) views cognitivism as the thought process behind behavior.

Name three theories belonging to the cognitivist paradigm.

The three theories are Piaget's Cognitive Development, Vygotsky's Socio-Cultural Theory, and the Information Processing Approach.

What are the three basic steps in the Information Processing Approach?

The three basic steps are encoding, storage, and retrieval.

Name three theories within the cognitivist paradigm and briefly describe each. Piaget's Cognitive Development: Piaget's theory suggests that children actively construct their understanding of the world and go through stages of cognitive development.

Vygotsky's Socio-Cultural Theory: This theory is based on developmental analysis, the role of language, and social relations in cognitive development.

The Information Processing Approach: Green (2003) proposed this approach, which involves three basic steps: encoding, storage, and retrieval in cognitive processes.

Topic-032: Language and Cognition-Cognitive Perceptual Processes What is the relationship between language and cognition in cognitive development?

Language is considered one of the most important psychological tools that affect children's cognitive development.

What is egocentric or private speech, and how does it relate to cognitive development?

Children begin to use egocentric or private speech to control their own thinking, which is part of their cognitive development.

Name two key concepts related to cognitive perceptual processes.

Two key concepts are "schema" and the "Three-Stage Information Processing Model."

Topic-033: Strategies of Development

What is the process of cognitive development, and what does it involve? Cognitive development is the process by which young children grow and change in their abilities. It involves senses and relationships, exploring objects, and interaction with adults, as well as logical and reasoning skills.

Who introduced the nine levels of learning events for the enhancement of cognitive skills, and how are they encouraged in language teaching? Robert Gagne introduced the nine levels of learning events. They are encouraged in language teaching to help design activities for developing students' cognitive skills.

Name the nine levels of learning events introduced by Robert Gagne. The nine levels are: Gain attention, Inform of objectives, Stimulate prior knowledge recall, Present stimulus, Provide learning guideline, Elicit performance, Provide feedback, Assess performance, and Enhance retention and transfer.

Lesson-09

COGNITIVISM-II

Topic-034: Piagetian Stages of Development

Who was Jean Piaget?

Jean Piaget was a Swiss clinical psychologist known for his work in child development.

What is a schema in Piaget's theory?

A schema is a basic building block of intelligent behavior, a way of organizing knowledge.

What are the three adaptation processes in Piaget's theory?

Assimilation, accommodation, and equilibrium.

Name the four stages of cognitive development in Piaget's theory.

Sensorimotor, Preoperational, Concrete Operational, and Formal Operational.

What are the four stages of cognitive development introduced by Jean Piaget?

Jean Piaget introduced the following stages of cognitive development:

Sensorimotor, Preoperational, Concrete Operational, and Formal Operational. **Topic-035: Multi-Store Model (Richard Shiffrin) on Cognitivism Who proposed the Atkinson-Shiffrin model of memory?**

Richard Atkinson and Richard Shiffrin.

What are the three memory stores in the Multi-Store Model?

Sensory Memory, Short-Term Memory, and Long-Term Memory.

What is the capacity of Short-Term Memory according to the model?

7 +/- 2 items.

What kind of encoding is associated with Long-Term Memory in the model?

Mainly semantic, but it can also be visual and auditory.

What are the criticisms faced by the Multi-Store Model?

The model has faced criticisms, including the view that sensory stores are not memory systems, the evidence that information can reside between short-term and long-term memory, and the belief in the existence of many parallel memory systems. Critics also claim that the model does not emphasize unconscious processes.

Topic-036: The Competition Model and the Associative-Cognitive CREED Theory (Ellis, 2002)

What are the dominant features of the Competition Model in language acquisition?

Lexical Functionalism, Connectionism, Input-Driven Learning, and Capacity.

Who introduced the Associative-Cognitive CREED Theory?

Nick Ellis.

What are some key principles of the Associative-Cognitive CREED Theory? Construction Grammar, Rational Language Processing, Exemplar-Based Abstraction and Attraction, Emergent Relations, and Dialectic. **Topic-037: Rumelhart and McLelland on Connectionism What is Connectionism in cognitive science?**

It's an interdisciplinary approach to the study of cognition that integrates elements from AI, neuroscience, cognitive psychology, and philosophy of mind.

What are the three key components of Parallel Distributed Processing (PDP) models?

A set of processing units, a set of modifiable connections between units, and a learning procedure (optional).

Who are the authors of the PDP model framework?

Rumelhart, Hinton, and McClelland.

What are the 8 major components of the PDP model framework, as stated by Rumelhart, Hinton, and McClelland?

The 8 major components of the PDP model framework are a set of processing units, a state of activation, an output function for each unit, a pattern of connectivity among units, a propagation rule for patterns of activities, an activation rule, a learning rule to modify connectivity, and the environment within which the system operates.

Topic-038: Newell and Simon's Theory of Information Processing

What did Newell and Simon propose in their theory of information processing?

An information processing system for problem solving.

What does the problem space refer to in their theory?

It refers to the analysis of problem solving from an information processing perspective.

What are the components of an information processing system according to Newell and Simon?

Receptors, Processors, Memories, and Effectors.

Lesson-10

CONSTRUCTIVISM-I

Topic-040: Principles of Constructivism

What is the key idea behind Constructivism theory?

The key idea behind Constructivism theory is that experiences enable people to construct knowledge about the world around them.

What are the key features of Constructivism?

The key features of Constructivism include being learner-centered and emphasizing environmental awareness.

According to Jonassen and Land, what are the basis of constructivist learning?

According to Jonassen and Land, context, construction, and collaboration are the basis of constructivist learning.

How many branches of Constructivism are there, and what are they?
There are two branches of Constructivism: Cognitive Constructivism and Social Constructivism.

What does Constructivism encourage in terms of learning?
Constructivism encourages the construction of knowledge rather than memorization.

Who introduced the theory of Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD), and what does it explain?

Vygotsky introduced the theory of Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD), which explains the distance between a learner's existing developmental state and their potential development.

What are the key principles of Constructivism, and how do they guide the learning process?

The key principles of Constructivism include:

Learning should start with issues that learners are actively trying to construct meaning around.

The learning process should focus on primary concepts rather than isolated facts.

Encouraging the construction of knowledge rather than memorization.
Providing learners with information on the quality of their learning, promoting self-assessment and reflection.

Topic-041: John Dewey's Notion of Experiential Education

Who is considered the father of experiential education?

John Dewey is considered the father of experiential education.

What is the main idea behind John Dewey's notion of experiential education? John Dewey's notion of experiential education emphasizes the importance of students' actual life experiences in developing their understanding of the world.

What are some key features of John Dewey's experiential education concept? Some key features of John Dewey's experiential education concept include acknowledging individual differences, serving a social purpose, supporting progressive education, and the theory of experience.

What are the two cornerstones of experiential education according to John Dewey?

The two cornerstones of experiential education, as claimed by John Dewey, are continuity and interaction.

What does John Dewey emphasize in experiential education? John Dewey emphasizes continual reorganization, reconstruction, and transformation of experience, reflective thinking, the learner as an explorer, and the perception of relationships in problematical situations, democracy, and education.

What are the main features of John Dewey's notion of experiential education, and why are continuity and interaction considered cornerstones? The main features of John Dewey's notion of experiential education include acknowledging individual differences, serving a social purpose, supporting progressive education, and emphasizing the Theory of Experience. Continuity and interaction are considered cornerstones because they underpin the effective functioning of experiential education. Continuity relates to continual reorganization and transformation of experience, while interaction involves reflective thinking, the learner as an explorer, and perceiving relationships in problematic situations, which are all crucial aspects of experiential education. **Topic-042: Frederick's Schematic Account of Memory (Remembering) Who proposed the theory of Reconstructive Memory and Schema?** Sir Frederick Bartlett proposed the theory of Reconstructive Memory and Schema.

What are the two methods suggested by Bartlett regarding remembering? The two methods suggested by Bartlett regarding remembering are repeated reproduction and serial reproduction.

How did Elizabeth Loftus contribute to Bartlett's idea of schemas? Elizabeth Loftus claimed that when we reconstruct memories, we change them by incorporating new information learned after the incident, and the original part of the memory cannot be determined or retrieved.

According to Elizabeth Loftus, what did she assert about eyewitnesses? Elizabeth Loftus asserted that eyewitnesses are unreliable

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